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LinkedIn Pathways

A personalised career-growth platform

Product Owner: Abrar



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Executive Summary

- Career change is accelerating, but people still stitch together fragmented advice, courses and networking.

- LinkedIn Pathways turns a member profile and career goal into a measurable skill plan, then connects learning to credible opportunities.

Ask: fund a 12-month MVP for 1.0M invited members and 50 employer partners.

Background

Why are we here?

- Career growth is surrounded by content, but professionals still struggle to decide what to do next.
- The World Economic Forum estimates that 39% of workers' skills may change or become outdated by 2030.
- LinkedIn already connects people, skills, roles and companies, creating a strong foundation for personalised career guidance.

From profile to progress.

Business Case

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Initial Focus

The gap is confidence, not content

- LinkedIn already knows a member’s skills, interests and professional graph, yet career growth still feels like guesswork.

39% of workers’ current skills may change or become outdated by 2030.
Members need a clear next step, not another catalogue of courses.
Start with mid-career digital professionals in the UK, US and Canada.

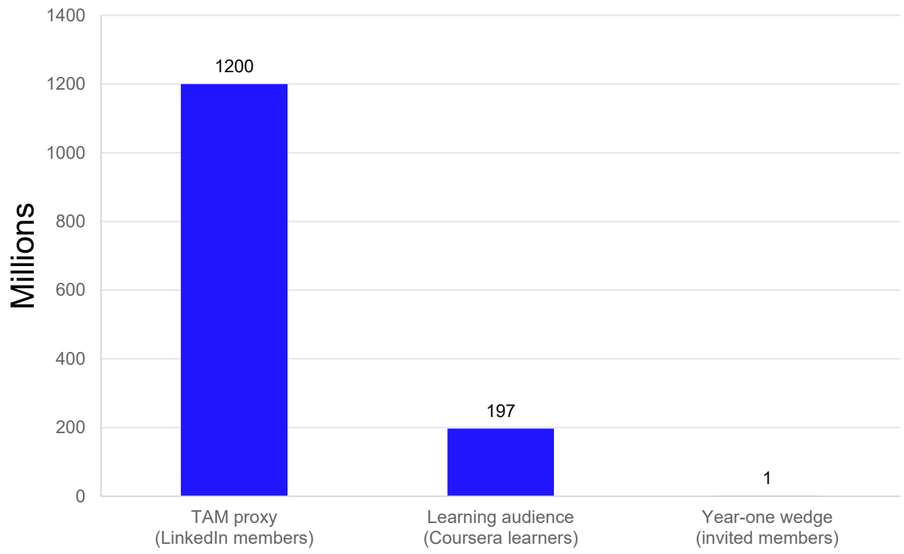
Call to action: approve discovery and a 12-month MVP.

Source: World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Report 2025; assumptions labelled in notes.

Opportunity

Skills change faster than plans

- The market is large, but the first wedge is narrow.
- TAM proxy: 1.2B LinkedIn members.
- Adjacent proof: 197M Coursera learners.
- First wedge: 10M members in the UK, US and Canada.
- Year one: invite 1M and activate 100,000.
- Assumption: $60 net revenue per activated member.



Sources: LinkedIn News, Q4 FY25 highlights; Coursera 2025 Form 10-K; assumptions labelled.

Proposal

One plan from profile to progress

- LinkedIn Pathways combines a skills graph, a goal-based plan and opportunity proof.

Diagnose: compare profile skills with target-role requirements.

Recommend: rank courses, projects, certifications and people to meet.

Coach: show weekly actions and explain why each matters.

Prove: turn completed work into verified profile signals.

Target users: mid-career professionals changing role or industry.

Return On Investment

A small bet can pay back quickly

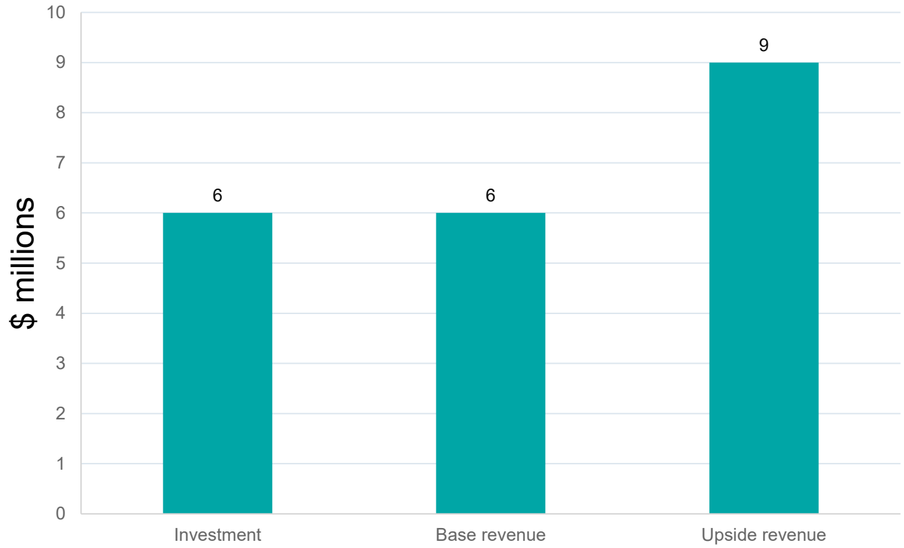
- Investment: $6.0M for 12 months.

Base: 100,000 members × $60 = $6.0M revenue.

Base ROI: 0%.

Upside: 150,000 members = $9.0M, or 50% ROI.

Scale only if activation exceeds 10% and 90-day return exceeds 35%.



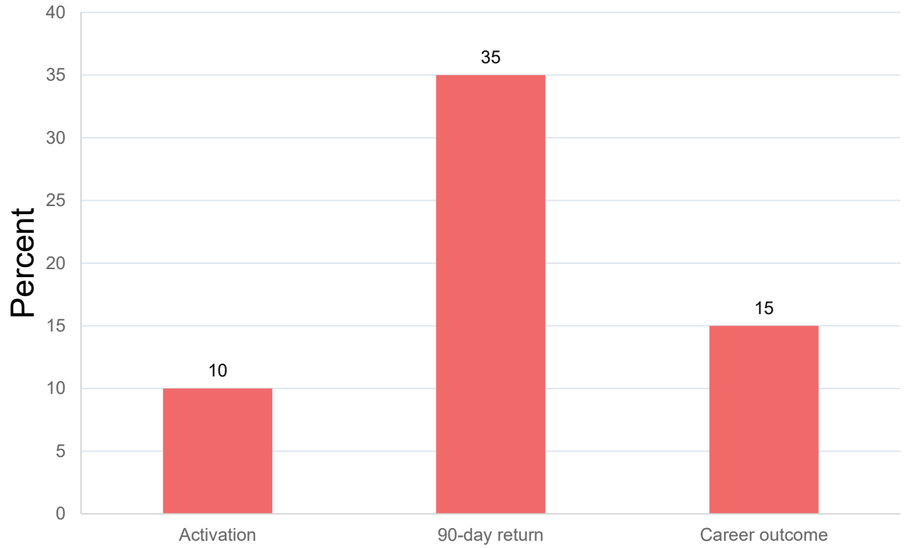
Measurement

Activation and outcomes matter

- First-year goals:

- 1.0M invited and 100,000 activated.
- 35% return in 90 days.
- 25% complete an action in 30 days.
- 15% report a career outcome in six months.
- 50 employer partners.

- Guardrails: quality, fairness, privacy and conversion.



Competitors

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Coursera

Learning catalog leaders

- Coursera offers a broad learning marketplace with:

- University and industry courses
- Professional certificates and degrees
- Skills tracks and personalised discovery
- Consumer and enterprise plans

- Its 197M registered learners prove demand. Its gap for LinkedIn is the missing professional graph and live hiring context.

Source: Coursera 2025 Form 10-K / SEC; competitor feature summary is directional.

LinkedIn Learning + Udemy

Career tools and marketplaces

- Adjacent products already provide:

- Video courses and assessments
- Skill recommendations and search
- Certificates and profile badges
- Employer or enterprise learning plans

- The market is validated, but advice remains fragmented. Pathways links the plan to a member’s target role, network and evidence of progress.

Source: LinkedIn Skills Signal Report 2025; positioning and differentiation are model hypotheses.

Our Advantages

LinkedIn can connect the missing pieces

- Why us:

- First-party professional graph: goals, skills, roles, companies and relationships in one context.
- Live labour-market signals: recommendations reflect changing demand, not a static curriculum.
- Opportunity proof: projects and credentials become portable profile evidence.
- Two-sided value: members gain direction while employers find emerging skills.

- Positioning: the career operating layer between learning and work.

Roadmap and Vision

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Roadmap Pillars

Make career growth feel navigable

- Vision: every professional can see the next credible step in their career and make measurable progress toward it.

- Year-one strategy has two themes:

- Personalised skill intelligence
- Trusted pathways and momentum

- A third theme follows after product-market fit: employer signal and internal mobility.

Theme 1: Personalised skill intelligence

Skill intelligence

- Three connected features make the recommendation explainable.

- Goal-to-skill map: translates a target role into a shortfall view.
- Market pulse: refreshes priority skills from current role and hiring data.
- Next-best action: ranks one practical learning or networking step each week.

Theme 2: Trusted pathways and momentum

Progress that compounds

- Three features turn advice into sustained behaviour.

- Curated pathways: combines LinkedIn Learning, partners and member-created projects.
- Proof of work: captures assessed outputs, endorsements and verified credentials.
- Progress coach: uses reminders, reflection and outcomes to adapt the plan.

Theme 3: Employer signal and internal mobility

Expansion after proof

- Build after the member loop works.

- Skills-first matching: helps employers search beyond titles and degrees.
- Internal opportunity exchange: surfaces adjacent roles and projects.
- Partner analytics: shows which pathways produce interviews, moves and hires.

Widening the scope

The platform can become career infrastructure

- Once the member loop is proven, Pathways can expand into:

- Employer-sponsored development plans
- Internal mobility and redeployment
- Learning partners and credential verification
- Career transitions for students and returners

- Decision today: fund discovery, recruit design partners and return with a tested MVP gate in 90 days.